

Hermes Agent Setup Guide

Syndrax Sync — Local + VPS Deployment with Discord Notifications

Overview

This guide sets up Hermes Agent on a cheap VPS to autonomously build and test TypeScript/JavaScript automation for your eBay seller tools. Your local Windows machine handles the browser and eBay account (keeping your IP safe), while the VPS runs the agent logic and sends you Discord updates.

Component	Where it runs	Purpose
Hermes Agent	VPS (\$5-6/mo)	Orchestration, memory, skills, Discord
AI Model (Ollama)	Your PC (RTX 3070)	Local LLM inference — free
Browser / eBay	Your PC (hermes-worker account)	Automation, keeps your home IP
Code Files	Your PC (hermes-worker account)	TypeScript/JS for Syndrax Sync

PHASE 1 — Windows Local Setup

Step 1.1 — Create a Dedicated Windows Account

Go to Settings > Accounts > Family & other users > Add someone else to this PC

- Name the account: **hermes-worker**
- Set account type to **Standard User** (not Administrator)
- Create a strong password and write it down
- Log into that account once to initialize it

Step 1.2 — Enable OpenSSH Server on Windows

Go to Settings > Apps > Optional Features > Add a feature > OpenSSH Server

- Install **OpenSSH Server**
- Open PowerShell as Admin and run:

```
Start-Service sshd
Set-Service -Name sshd -StartupType Automatic
```
- Allow SSH through Windows Firewall (usually auto-done)
- Test SSH locally: `ssh hermes-worker@localhost`

Step 1.3 — Install Ollama (Local AI Model)

- Download Ollama from **ollama.com** and install it
- Verify NVIDIA drivers are up to date (run `nvidia-smi` in PowerShell)
- Install CUDA Toolkit from `nvidia.com` (match version to your driver)

- Pull the coding model — run in PowerShell:

```
ollama pull qwen2.5-coder:7b
```

- Test it: ollama run qwen2.5-coder:7b

RTX 3070 has 8GB VRAM — a 7B quantized model fits comfortably.

Step 1.4 — Set Up Code Workspace in hermes-worker Account

- Log into hermes-worker account
 - Create folder: C:\hermes-workspace\syndrax-sync
 - Copy your Syndrax Sync project files into that folder
 - Install Node.js / Bun under this account
 - Install VS Code CLI (code command) under this account
 - Set up Chrome with your eBay account logged in under this account only
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PHASE 2 — VPS Setup

Step 2.1 — Create Your VPS

- Sign up at **Linode (Akamai)** or **Vultr**
- Create a \$5-6/mo instance — Ubuntu 22.04 LTS
- Save your VPS IP address and root credentials
- SSH into your VPS: ssh root@YOUR_VPS_IP

Step 2.2 — Install Hermes Agent on VPS

Run this one-liner on your VPS:

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/NousResearch/hermes-agent/main/scripts/install.sh | bash
```

- Follow the installer prompts
- Run hermes --version to confirm install

Step 2.3 — Configure Hermes to Use Your Local Ollama

- In Hermes config, set model provider to: **OpenAI-compatible endpoint**
- Set endpoint URL to: http://YOUR_HOME_IP:11434
- Set model to: qwen2.5-coder:7b

Make sure port 11434 is open on your home router/firewall for the VPS IP only.

Step 2.4 — Configure SSH Backend (VPS to Your Windows PC)

- In Hermes config, set terminal backend to: **SSH**
- Set SSH host: YOUR_HOME_IP
- Set SSH user: hermes-worker

- Set SSH key or password auth for hermes-worker account
 - Set working directory: C:\hermes-workspace\syndrax-sync
 - Test the connection from VPS: hermes test-connection
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PHASE 3 — Discord Integration

Step 3.1 — Create a Discord Bot

- Go to **discord.com/developers** and create a new application
- Go to Bot tab > Add Bot > copy the Bot Token
- Invite bot to your personal Discord server

Step 3.2 — Connect Discord to Hermes

- In Hermes messaging config, select Discord platform
 - Paste your Bot Token
 - Set your personal Discord channel as the notification target
 - Test: ask Hermes to send a test message to Discord
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PHASE 4 — First Run & Testing

Step 4.1 — Verify the Full Chain

- VPS can SSH into hermes-worker account on your Windows PC
- Hermes can read/write files in C:\hermes-workspace\syndrax-sync
- Hermes can call Ollama model on your PC
- Hermes sends Discord notification on task completion

Step 4.2 — First Automation Task

Start simple — ask Hermes to:

- List files in your Syndrax Sync project folder
 - Read your package.json and summarize dependencies
 - Identify one TypeScript file and describe what it does
 - Report findings to Discord
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Security Reminders

- hermes-worker account should NOT have admin privileges

- Only open port 11434 (Ollama) to your VPS IP — not the whole internet
- Your eBay Chrome profile stays ONLY on the hermes-worker account
- Never store eBay credentials in any config file on the VPS
- Regularly check what Hermes has access to as you expand its permissions

Come back after completing Phase 1 — Windows account setup. We'll troubleshoot and start Phase 2 together.